Contours

Contour is universal method to show the relief. The unit of measurement of contour is generally metres above the mean sea level. Contour has an advantage that it does not hide the other features drawn on the toposheet. Reading contours is a skill that helps us to understand the actual landscape. The skill can be obtained by understanding the salient features of contours. They are as follows:

1. Contours are drawn at regular intervals in brown colour. Generally 20m interval is followed in 1:50,000 and 100m interval in 1:250,000 toposheet.
2. Every fifth contour is a dark line to enhance map reading.
3. The value of contour is printed by breaking the contour line andalso given at the edge of the toposheet.
4. Generally contours never cut or cross each other. In case of water fall and cliffs contours almost touch a same point or a line. In over hanging cliff the contours cut each other.

Figure 10.10 gives the general features shown by contours.

Drawing Cross Section from Contours

The following figure shows the way two adjacent hills are shown by contours.

a) Two adjacent hills shown by contour

Drawing cross section of the contours allows one to know the exact landform

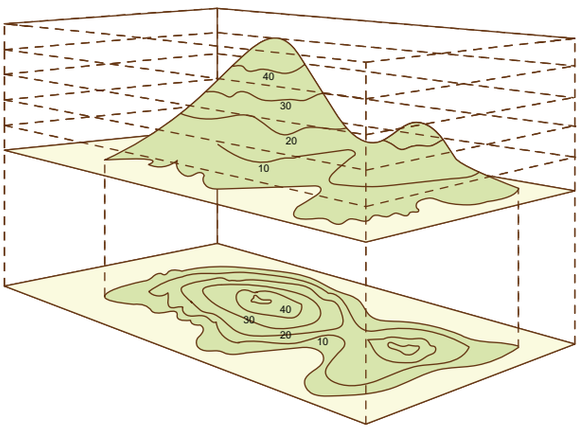


Figure 10.9 Two adjacent hills

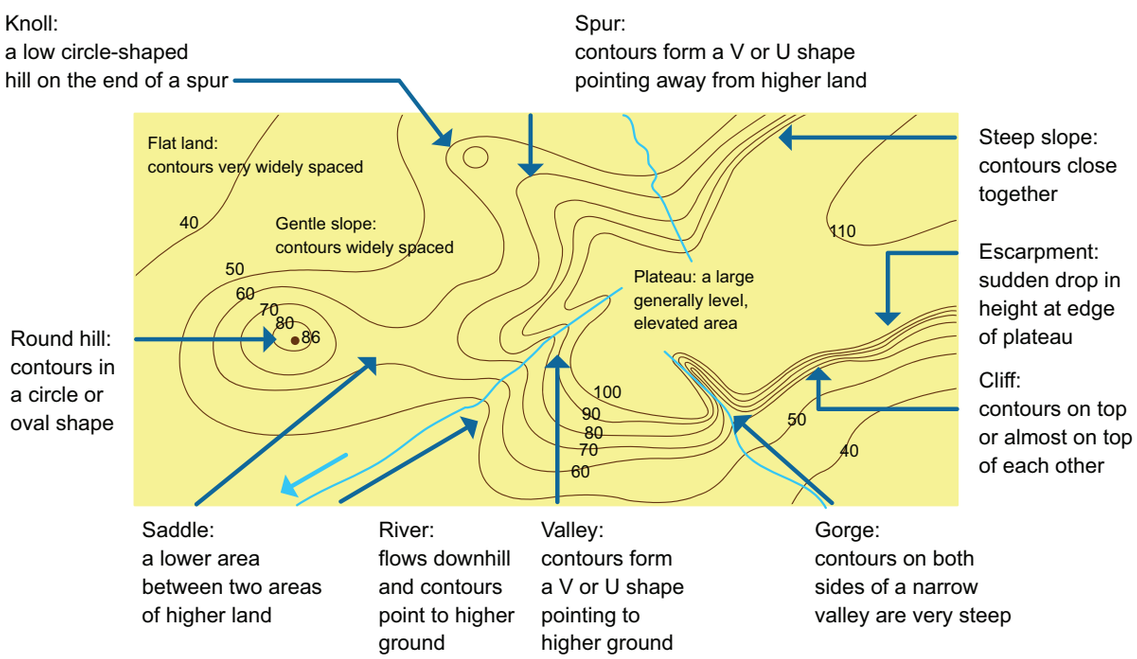


Figure 10.10 Contours of different land features

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